while walking. Walk cycles are the most important part of video game animation; if a character has to move, they'll need a perfect walk cycle. Because it's a fantastic method to get acquainted with the rig while also establishing a personality, the walk cycle is definitely the first screen test done for any new character in a series or a film. Let's have a look at how to make the walk cycle in Blender.

Inside Blender, you must first understand the fundamental formula before you can begin animating a cycle. That's correct; when it comes to making a perfect cycle, there are some tried-and-true methods that will help you construct a convincing walk cycle each time. This method is for a very simple walk, such as going down the street or strolling through a mall.

There are four primary postures, with approximately 12 frames each step, for 24 frames. The major stances included in a walk cycle will provide you with the basis for a wonderful stroll. Surely, the positions may be adjusted and increased as required, but the body's motion during a stroll can be seen. The "Vanilla Walk" is a term that is used in the animation industry to describe this sort of walk cycle.

Because we'll be creating a vanilla walk cycle, we won't stray too far from this fundamental framework in our posing. A fast Google search for "Walk Cycle" will yield many photos depicting the major positions and timing involved. However, it's still a good idea to look for video examples online or even get out and film some yourself.

Make sure you carefully register this in your mind, about the motions your body makes while walking, and pay close attention to the reference video to see how the weight shifts from one side to another side and how the hips, arms, shoulders and upper body rotate. The more preparation you do ahead of time, the more perfect the result will be.

Creating the Walk Cycle's Contact Positions

We'll be using the traditional DT Puppet. DT Puppet is a great rig for body mechanics. The contact position is the first step that you'll need to set with each walk you make. There will be a total of three contact locations in a 24-frame walk cycle.

Change the frame range in the Blender scene to terminate at frame 25, making it a looping walk animation. Set the keying channel to LocRotScale as well so that each channel receives a keyframe. Select the tiny red symbol next to the keying box to activate auto keying, which means that a keyframe will accompany any changes you make.